



STUDENT PORTAL

Safety, Respect & Community Support

A direct student guide to boundaries, harassment, discrimination, bullying, violence, online conduct, reporting, and recovery.

You can ask for help before you have the right label.

If something felt threatening, humiliating, sexual, discriminatory, coercive, or unsafe, speak with a trusted adult. You do not need perfect proof, witnesses, or a complete memory before asking for support.

Demo prototype edition

This guide is an independent educational demo, not an official school publication. Local contacts, emergency processes, reporting routes, confidentiality statements, and response procedures are illustrative placeholders, not approved instructions.



01 Start here

This guide is written for students. It explains what harmful behavior can look like, why it matters, and what you can do without placing responsibility for the harm on you.

If you need help now

1. If anyone may be in immediate danger, move toward a safer place and contact a nearby trusted adult or the school's approved emergency contact now.
2. If there is no immediate danger, tell a trusted teacher, counselor, safeguarding lead, administrator, parent, or guardian.
3. If speaking is difficult, show the adult a written message such as: 'Something happened and I need help. I am not ready to explain everything yet.'

A freeze, silence, or nervous laugh is not permission.

People can react to shock by freezing, going quiet, trying to keep the peace, or remembering details later. These reactions do not make the experience less real and do not transfer responsibility away from the person who crossed the boundary.

What is inside

02 The community standard

Dignity, respect, disagreement, and responsibility.

03 Know the differences

Conflict, harm, bullying, harassment, discrimination, and violence.

04 Boundaries and consent

How to recognize and respect a limit.

05 Harassment

Verbal, social, physical, sexual, and digital conduct.

06 Discrimination

Identity-based harm, exclusion, stereotypes, and unequal treatment.

07 Bullying and power

Repetition, power imbalance, and group behavior.

08 Violence and threats

Immediate safety and prohibited behavior.

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Messages, images, rumors, accounts, and evidence.

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11 Respond and support

Steps for the person affected, witnesses, and the person responsible.

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What to share and what a safe response should include.

13 Scripts and resources

Words you can use and the evidence behind this guide.

02 The community standard

A safe school is built through everyday conduct and through a reliable response when someone is harmed.

Respect is not agreement

You will not agree with every opinion, school decision, teaching style, or classmate. Respect means handling disagreement without humiliation, intimidation, pressure, exclusion, or personal abuse.

You may criticize an idea or decision. You may not turn a person into a target.

Respect works in every direction

Students deserve safety, fair treatment, and a meaningful opportunity to be heard. Teachers and staff deserve to work without harassment or personal abuse. A person's role changes their responsibilities, not their basic dignity.

Impact, intent, and responsibility

Intent helps explain an action, but it does not erase its impact. A person can cause harm without planning to. Once a boundary is communicated or discomfort is clear, continuing is a choice.

Before you speak, post, or act

Ask: Am I criticizing a situation or attacking a person? Am I sharing something that is mine to share? Has this person asked me to stop? Would this action make participation, learning, or belonging harder for them?

What every student can expect

- Concerns should be heard without ridicule or immediate blame.
- A student should not be required to confront the other person alone.
- A report should be handled as privately as the school's duties allow.
- Retaliation, intimidation, and pressure after a report are further concerns and should be reported.
- Support should not depend on whether an investigation has reached a final conclusion.

03 Know the differences

Labels can help us respond, but they must never become barriers to support. A situation may fit more than one category.

Term	Direct meaning	What matters
Conflict	A disagreement or clash in which the people involved may have relatively equal power.	Conflict can still become harmful. Use calm resolution only when everyone can participate safely.
Disrespect	Conduct that dismisses dignity or reasonable boundaries.	A single disrespectful action may need correction even if it is not bullying or harassment.
Bullying	Deliberate, unwanted aggression involving a real or perceived power imbalance and repetition or a likelihood of repetition.	Power may come from popularity, numbers, status, strength, authority, or access to information.
Harassment	Unwelcome verbal, written, visual, digital, physical, or sexual conduct that targets, intimidates, humiliates, threatens, or interferes with safety or participation.	It can be repeated or a single serious incident. School policy and applicable law determine formal findings.
Discrimination	Unfair treatment or exclusion connected to identity, background, belief, disability, sex, or another protected or personal characteristic.	It may involve a rule, decision, stereotype, insult, exclusion, or harassment.
Violence	The threatened or actual use of physical force or power that may cause injury, psychological harm, deprivation, or other serious harm.	Threats, assault, coercion, and technology-facilitated violence require prompt action.

Do not wait for the perfect category

If conduct is frightening, sexual, discriminatory, coercive, humiliating, persistent, or unsafe, tell a trusted adult. The school is responsible for deciding which procedures apply.

04 Boundaries and consent

A boundary is a limit that protects physical space, privacy, personal information, comfort, identity, or emotional wellbeing.

How a boundary may be communicated

- Direct words: 'No,' 'Stop,' 'Do not call me that,' or 'Do not share that.'
- Actions: moving away, ending a chat, blocking an account, pulling back, or returning an item.
- Signs of uncertainty or discomfort: silence, hesitation, freezing, avoiding contact, or looking distressed.
- A previously stated limit: permission in the past does not remove the right to set a different boundary now.

Consent must be active and specific

Consent is a clear and voluntary agreement to a particular action. Pressure, fear, manipulation, intoxication, incapacity, or an authority imbalance can make genuine agreement impossible. Consent can be withdrawn at any time.

The practical rule

When someone says no, asks you to stop, pulls away, freezes, or appears unsure: stop. Check in. Do not argue, punish, mock, bargain, or continue until they give in.

Boundaries apply to

Bodies and space

Touching, blocking movement, play fighting, taking belongings, photography.

Words and jokes

Nicknames, comments, questions, teasing, rumors, sexual language.

Privacy

Messages, images, medical information, family matters, identity, location.

Participation

Clubs, games, dares, relationships, conversations, online groups.

Authority creates extra responsibility

Adults and student leaders must not use authority, grades, access, status, recommendations, team selection, or privileges to obtain personal or sexual compliance. A student should report any request or pressure of this kind immediately.

05 Harassment

Harassment is not made harmless by calling it a joke, tradition, rumor, compliment, or private conversation.

It can look like

- repeated teasing, mocking, insults, demeaning nicknames, or making one person the entertainment;
- threats, intimidation, stalking, following, blocking movement, or deliberate isolation;
- sexual comments, noises, gestures, questions, requests, images, touching, or rumors that are unwelcome;
- comments about race, nationality, language, religion, sex, gender, disability, sexual orientation, body, appearance, or background;
- sharing private messages, images, or personal information;
- encouraging others to join, laugh, exclude, rate, shame, or target someone;
- retaliating because a person resisted, sought help, supported someone, or made a report.

A single incident can still be serious

Bullying definitions usually emphasize repetition and a power imbalance. Harassment, sexual misconduct, threats, assault, discriminatory conduct, or another serious breach may require action after one incident. Do not assume 'it only happened once' means it should be ignored.

Unwelcome sexual conduct

Sexual harassment may be verbal, nonverbal, visual, physical, or digital. It can be committed by a student, adult, visitor, or another person connected to school activities. The people involved can be of any sex or gender.

Quiet does not mean harmless

A sexual or degrading comment spoken too quietly for others to hear can still shock, humiliate, or frighten the person targeted. A lack of witnesses is not a reason to stay silent or a requirement for seeking support.

What is not an excuse

- 'Everyone laughed.' A group reaction does not create consent.
- 'They did not say no.' Shock, fear, or freezing can prevent an immediate response.
- 'I did not mean it.' Intent does not remove responsibility for impact or for stopping.
- 'It was private.' Private conduct can still be harmful and reportable.
- 'They joke too.' Each person's boundaries still apply.

06 Discrimination and identity-based harm

Differences between people must never become reasons for humiliation, exclusion, inferior treatment, or abuse.

Identity-based harm may involve

- racism or targeting race, ethnicity, nationality, skin color, accent, language, or cultural background;
- sexism, sexual harassment, gender stereotypes, or targeting gender identity or expression;
- religious discrimination, hostility toward belief or non-belief, or pressure concerning religious practice;
- ableism, disability-related insults, exclusion, imitation, denial of reasonable access, or misuse of health information;
- homophobia, transphobia, outing, slurs, rumors, or hostility connected to sexual orientation or gender identity;
- body shaming or humiliating comments about appearance, size, development, clothing, or physical characteristics;
- class-based, family-background, immigration-status, or other identity-related humiliation.

Curiosity is not a free pass

Questions about identity can be respectful when the other person is willing to discuss them. No student owes classmates personal explanations, private information, or permission to debate their identity.

Stereotypes can cause harm even without an insult

Assuming that someone is naturally less capable, dangerous, dishonest, unintelligent, overly emotional, or responsible for the actions of a group can shape exclusion and unequal treatment.

Critique ideas without attacking identity

A school can support open discussion and still require dignity. Focus criticism on a claim, decision, or action. Do not use identity as a weapon, demand personal disclosure, or turn a classmate into the representative of an entire group.

Report patterns as well as incidents

A series of small actions can create a serious environment even when each event is dismissed on its own. When possible, note dates, words used, decisions made, witnesses, and changes in access or participation.

07 Bullying, groups, and power

Bullying is not simply any disagreement. It involves unwanted aggression, a power imbalance, and repetition or a strong likelihood that the behavior will be repeated.

Power is more than physical strength

- social influence, popularity, seniority, or control of a group;
- greater physical size, strength, numbers, or access to weapons;
- authority, leadership, special access, or control of opportunities;
- knowledge of private information, images, passwords, or secrets;
- language ability, confidence, wealth, technology access, or social connections.

Common forms

Verbal

Threats, taunts, insults, name-calling, degrading sexual or identity-based comments.

Social

Rumors, public embarrassment, organized exclusion, friendship pressure.

Physical

Hitting, pushing, tripping, spitting, taking or damaging belongings.

Digital

Posts, messages, impersonation, image sharing, dogpiling, exclusion, repeated contact.

Why students may not report

A student may fear retaliation, loss of friends, being called weak, not being believed, losing device access, exposing private information, or making the situation bigger. Adults should respond calmly and should not blame a student for waiting.

Witnesses change the balance

Do not laugh, like, forward, or join. Move toward the person being targeted, check in privately, save relevant information when safe, and tell a trusted adult. You can help without confronting anyone or putting yourself in danger.

08 Violence, threats, and coercion

Violence can be physical, sexual, psychological, or technology-facilitated. Threats and coercion can cause serious harm even when no physical injury occurs.

Treat these as urgent concerns

- a weapon, credible threat, physical assault, strangulation, forced confinement, or blocked escape;
- sexual assault, forced sexual contact, sexual coercion, grooming, or requests by an adult for secrecy or sexual content;
- threats to expose private information or images unless someone complies;
- stalking, repeated unwanted following, location tracking, or account intrusion;
- threats of self-harm or harm to others used to control another person;
- group violence, hazing, forced dares, or punishment disguised as initiation or tradition.

Immediate safety

If danger may be immediate: do not investigate or confront the person yourself. Move to a safer place, alert a nearby adult, and use the school's approved emergency process. If school help is not available and danger is immediate, contact the local emergency service.

Coercion means pressure that removes a free choice

Coercion can involve threats, blackmail, persistence after refusal, social punishment, authority, money, grades, access, secrets, emotional manipulation, or exploiting intoxication or vulnerability.

Never promise total secrecy

If a friend tells you about serious harm, listen and be honest: you may need adult help to protect them. Share only with people who need to help; do not spread the story among peers.

09 Online harm and digital boundaries

Online behavior affects real people. Private groups, anonymous accounts, gaming spaces, and disappearing messages do not remove responsibility.

Examples

- repeated unwanted messages, sexual requests, threats, or pressure to reply;
- sharing screenshots, images, recordings, location, or personal information without permission;
- impersonation, edited images, false accounts, rumors, polls, ratings, or public humiliation;
- excluding someone from necessary class communication or organizing others to isolate them;
- sexual image abuse, threats to share intimate material, grooming, or demands for more content;
- hacking, password misuse, device monitoring, or location tracking.

If it happens online

1. Prioritize safety. Do not keep responding if contact feels threatening or coercive.
2. Preserve useful information only when safe: screenshots, account names, links, dates, times, and a short description of context.
3. Use platform blocking and reporting tools when appropriate, but do not assume blocking replaces telling a trusted adult.
4. Do not redistribute harmful or sexual content as 'evidence.' Show a trusted adult the safest way to preserve or report it.
5. Change passwords and review account, privacy, recovery, and location-sharing settings if access may be compromised.

If an intimate image involves a minor

Do not download, copy, forward, or store additional versions. Tell a safeguarding adult immediately and follow the school's approved procedure. The adult should obtain specialist or law-enforcement advice appropriate to the location.

Evidence is helpful, not a condition of support

Content may disappear or be unsafe to capture. Report what you remember. A student should never be required to keep viewing harmful material in order to prove what happened.

10 Real situations: does this count?

These examples explain the principle. A formal decision always depends on the full context and the school's approved procedure.

The joke continued

Situation: A student keeps using a nickname after being asked to stop. Friends laugh, and the student being targeted becomes quiet.

What it means: The request to stop established a boundary. Continuing makes the conduct unwelcome. Repetition and group power may also make it bullying.

The quiet sexual comment

Situation: Someone makes an unwanted sexual remark in a low voice, so nobody else appears to hear it.

What it means: The lack of witnesses does not make the conduct harmless. The student can report the words, setting, approximate time, and impact.

The group chat

Situation: Students create a private chat to mock a classmate and circulate screenshots of their messages.

What it means: Private digital humiliation and sharing personal content can be harassment, bullying, or both. Every person who adds, shares, or encourages the conduct contributes to the harm.

The identity debate

Situation: A student is repeatedly asked to defend their religion, nationality, disability, gender, or sexual orientation after saying they do not want to discuss it.

What it means: Academic discussion does not require a student to surrender personal boundaries or become a target. Continuing may become identity-based harassment.

The one-time threat

Situation: A student makes one credible threat of serious harm and says it cannot be bullying because it happened once.

What it means: It may not meet a technical bullying definition, but it is still a serious safety concern requiring immediate adult attention.

The apology without change

Situation: A person apologizes each time but repeats the same behavior.

What it means: An apology does not reset the pattern. Repetition after clear feedback shows that the boundary is not being respected.

11 Respond, witness, and take responsibility

There is no single perfect reaction. Choose the safest next step available to you.

If it happens to you

1. Move toward safety. You do not have to confront the person.
2. Tell a trusted adult. You can ask someone you trust to accompany you.
3. Write what you remember in your own words: what, when, where, who, possible witnesses, and what happened afterward.
4. Preserve relevant messages or other information when safe. Do not take risks to collect proof.
5. Ask what options exist, what will be shared, and what happens next.
6. Report retaliation or new contact immediately.

If you witness it

- If safe, interrupt briefly: 'Stop. That is not okay.'
- Create distance or ask an adult to come over.
- Check in privately: 'I saw what happened. Are you okay? Do you want help telling someone?'
- Do not demand details or promise secrecy you cannot keep.
- Record only what you personally observed. Do not add rumors.

If someone says you caused harm

1. Stop the behavior and give the person space.
2. Listen without interrupting, mocking, or demanding forgiveness.
3. Do not retaliate, recruit friends, delete or alter relevant information, or pressure the person to withdraw a concern.
4. Take responsibility for the action and its impact. Ask a trusted adult for help understanding expectations.
5. Follow any safety plan or school direction, and demonstrate change consistently.

A useful apology

Name what you did. Recognize the impact. Avoid excuses. Explain the specific change you will make. Respect that the other person may not want contact or immediate forgiveness.

12 Reporting and the school's response

A student should be able to seek support without first proving a case or choosing the correct formal process.

What you can share

- what happened, using the words you remember;
- where and approximately when it happened;
- who was involved and who may have seen or heard part of it;
- messages, account names, dates, or other information you already have;
- how the situation has affected safety, attendance, learning, sleep, relationships, or wellbeing;
- what you need now to feel safer or able to participate.

Questions you may ask

- Who will be told, and why?
- What can remain private, and what must be shared for safety?
- What happens next, and when will I receive an update?
- Can I bring a support person to meetings?
- How will the school prevent contact, retaliation, or disruption while the concern is reviewed?
- How can I correct or add information later?

A safe school response should

- listen calmly and take immediate safety needs seriously;
- explain confidentiality limits before asking for unnecessary detail;
- document the concern accurately and use trained staff to determine next steps;
- avoid blaming the reporting student or requiring direct confrontation;
- consider support and interim safety measures without assuming an outcome;
- review evidence fairly, protect all students from retaliation, and communicate appropriately;
- take proportionate action to stop harm, reduce recurrence, and address its effects.

Demo contact panel - illustrative placeholders only

Safeguarding contact: [ROLE / NAME] | Location: [OFFICE] | Contact: [METHOD] | Reporting route: [URL / LOCATION] | Urgent process: [APPROVED INSTRUCTION] | After-hours support: [APPROVED INSTRUCTION]

Important limitation

This guide explains educational principles, not a legal test or a guarantee of a particular outcome. The school's safeguarding policy, applicable law, and the facts of the situation govern the formal response.

13 Words you can use

You do not need a perfect explanation. Start with the clearest sentence you can manage.

Asking for help

- 'Something happened that made me feel unsafe. I need to speak privately.'
- 'I am not sure whether this is harassment, but I want help understanding what happened.'
- 'I froze and did not respond at the time. I want to report it now.'
- 'I do not have screenshots or witnesses. Can I still tell you what happened?'
- 'I can write it down, but I am not ready to say it aloud.'

Setting a boundary

- 'Stop. Do not say that to me again.'
- 'I do not consent to this being shared.'
- 'That question is personal. I am not discussing it.'
- 'Do not contact me outside the school process.'

Supporting someone

- 'I believe that this affected you. You did not deserve it.'
- 'You can decide how much you want to tell me.'
- 'Would you like me to go with you to a trusted adult?'
- 'I cannot promise total secrecy if someone may be in danger, but I will not spread this.'

Interrupting safely

- 'Stop. They asked you to stop.'
- 'Do not share that.'
- 'This is getting personal. Leave them out of it.'
- 'I am getting an adult.'

Support after an incident

Emotional shock can appear immediately or later. Difficulty concentrating, sleep changes, fear, anger, numbness, or avoiding a place or person can be signs that support would help. Speak with a school counselor, safeguarding adult, parent or guardian, or qualified health professional.

14 Evidence base and publication notes

This guide uses international public-health, education, child-rights, and official safeguarding sources. Definitions are adapted into student-facing language rather than copied as legal rules.

1. UNESCO. [Behind the numbers: ending school violence and bullying](#). 2019. Global evidence on school violence, bullying, consequences, and effective system responses.
2. UNESCO. [What you need to know about school violence and bullying](#). 2020. Whole-education approach and components of an effective response.
3. World Health Organization. [Violence against children](#). 2026. Forms of violence, bullying characteristics, impacts, and prevention.
4. World Health Organization. [Youth violence](#). 2026. Youth violence scope, consequences, and whole-school prevention.
5. World Health Organization. [What works to prevent online violence against children?](#). 2022. Online violence, peer and acquaintance risks, and prevention education.
6. UNICEF. [How to talk to your child about cyberbullying](#). accessed 2026. Supportive listening, documentation, school response, and non-blaming language.
7. UNICEF. [How to talk to your child's school about bullying](#). accessed 2026. Safe learning, school responsibility, bystander education, and constructive response.
8. StopBullying.gov. [What Is Bullying](#). reviewed 2024. Bullying definition, power imbalance, repetition, and verbal, social, and physical forms.
9. StopBullying.gov. [Warning Signs for Bullying](#). reviewed 2021. Why students may not report and indicators that support may be needed.
10. U.S. Department of Education, Office for Civil Rights. [Harassment and Bullying](#). reviewed 2026. Forms and educational impact of discriminatory harassment. Used as general recognition guidance, not as locally applicable law.

Editorial principles

- Behavior-first language: describe conduct and impact instead of fixing students into permanent labels.
- Support before proof: evidence can assist a review, but uncertainty must not block help.
- Safety before confrontation: students are not asked to investigate or resolve serious harm alone.
- Clear limits: the guide does not promise anonymity, total confidentiality, or a predetermined outcome.
- Prototype status: any institutional adaptation would require alignment with applicable law, safeguarding policy, and student-support capacity.

Demo prototype notes

Independent educational prototype | No institutional ownership or approval | Version: 1.0

Policy links: illustrative placeholders only